Dear Hiring Team at Halden Pay,

I am applying for the Senior Data Engineer – Data Platform position. I have nine years of experience building and operating production data platforms across logistics, e-commerce and payments, with hands-on experience in Python, SQL, Airflow, dbt and cloud data warehouses. Halden Pay's focus on a shared platform and reusable frameworks is a strong match for the work I have been doing.

At Lukovac Freight Hub, I own ingestion and orchestration for a central platform with approximately 140 Airflow DAGs, and migrated stored-procedure transformations into dbt, delivering 420+ tested models. I also participate in the data platform on-call rotation, helping keep production ingestion and orchestration reliable day to day. That work reduced the nightly build time from 5 hours 10 minutes to 1 hour 50 minutes. I also reduced Snowflake spend from approximately $38,000 to $24,000 per month through warehouse sizing, auto-suspend and removal of unused tables. I have also introduced JSON Schema data contracts and CI checks between product and data teams, and built Kafka pipelines processing around 30 million events per day. The associated CI checks reduced broken-pipeline incidents from approximately nine to two per month. These experiences have taught me to focus on reliable platform foundations, data quality and engineering practices that can be reused across teams.

My experience at Kovalent Pay is directly relevant to Halden Pay's business. I built PySpark jobs on AWS EMR to reconcile bank settlement files against internal ledgers, processing approximately 1.2 TB of raw files daily, and helped reduce month-end manual reconciliation work from around three days to four hours. I also designed a Redshift cloud data warehouse using dimensional modelling, with more than 30 fact and dimension tables for finance and risk teams. Alongside this cloud data platform experience, I have contributed two merged pull requests to an Airflow provider and presented on data contracts at a regional data meetup. I hold an MSc in Computer Science and an AWS Certified Data Engineer – Associate certification.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my experience designing and operating data platforms, defining data quality checks, and building reusable frameworks and tooling could support Halden Pay's Data Platform team and its business clients.

Kind regards,
Lena Varga-Holm
lenavh.dev